

GERÇEĞİN MATRİSİ ÜZERİNE TARİH: ERMENİ GREGORYEN KİLİSESİ MONOFİZİTİR VE ORTODOKS

HISTORY ON THE MATRIX OF TRUTH: THE ARMENIAN GREGORIAN CHURCH IS MONOPHYSITE AND NON-ORTHODOX

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ÖZ

Orta Çağ'ın başlarından biraz değiştirilmiş bir biçimde Ermeni Gregoryen Kilisesi, Monofizit inancının temel dayanağı olan 444'te oluşturulan Eftihisin öğretilerine bağlıdır. Ermeni-Gregoryen Kilisesi'nin Monofizitizminin tarihi, Kadıköy Konsili'nden sonra, Monofizitlerin göçebe Ermenilerin yaşadığı ve Parfiyalı Gregori tarafından 4. yüzyılda kurulan Ermeni Gregoryen Kilisesinin idare ettiği Fırat havzası topraklarına yönelmesiyle başladı. 491'de Ermeni-Gregoryen Kilisesi, İsa Mesih'te bir kişi olduğunu ilan ederek Kadıköy Konsili'ni reddetti. Devrim öncesi Rus apolojisti V.L. Velichko, yazılarında bu gerçekleri yazdı. Hatta ermeni din adamlarının kendileri, Orta Çağ'da Ermenilerin Monofizitizmi hakkında yazdılar. 6. yüzyılın ortalarında Ermeni Gregoryen Kilisesi Katolikosu Iohann mektuplarında şunu vurguladı: "Tek Tanrı'yı ikrar ediyoruz ... Tanrı Sözü'nün ikili, bölünmüş birliği değil." Yüzyıllar boyunca Monofizit Ermeni-Gregoryen Kilisesi dağınık cemaati için yeni bir ülke arıyordu ve 16. yüzyılın ortalarında çekirdeği "Büyük Ermenistan" miti olan "Ermeni sorunu"nu icat etti. Bu Monofizit kilisesi neredeyse iki yüzyıl boyunca Avrupa'nın dikkatini "büyük Ermenistan" mitine çekmeye çalıştı. 17. yüzyılın sonunda Ermeni Gregoryen Kilisesi'nin elçisi I. Ori, Avrupa'nın "Ermeni meselesine" kayıtsız kaldığına ikna olmuş, 18. yüzyılın başında umutla Romanov Rusya'sına dönmüştür. I. Ori'nin misyonu Başpiskopos İosif Argutinski tarafından sürdürüldü. Ori Rus mahkemesinin dikkatini hayali "Ermeni sorununa" çekmeye çalışarak I. Paul için bir ayın yazdı ve imparatoru Ermeni-Gregoryen Kilisesi'nin Rus Ortodoks Kilisesi gibi Ortodoks ve Monofizit Ermeni Kilisesi devamçılarının "hem Tüm Rusya'nın Ortodoks İmparatoru hem de Ağustos Evi için dua ediyor. "olduğuna ikna etti. Böylece, Rusya'da neredeyse 100 yıl boyunca, gezgin Ermeniler Ortodoks olarak kabul edildi ve ancak 1891'de Ermeni Kilisesi'nin "Ortodoksisi" hakkındaki bu efsane, Ermeni rahip Ter-Voskakov'un yargılanması sırasında ifşa edildi. Burada ayının her zaman Eçmiadzin Makamı tarafından hazırlanan ve XIX. yüzyılın yetmişli yıllarında Kevork VI tarafından onaylanan ayinlere göre yerine getirildiği ortaya çıktı. Bu ilahi hizmette, ne Rus imparatoru ne herhangi bir Egemen için ne de başka hiçbir Hristiyan için dua yoktu. Zamanımızın ünlü ilahiyatçıları Ermenilerin Monofizitizmi hakkında yazıyorlar. Selanik Metropolü Eski Protopresbiteri, Selanik Aristoteles Üniversitesi İlahiyat Fakültesi Profesörü Theodore Zisis "Ermeniler Ortodoks mu?" makalesinde vurgulanmıştır: "Ermeniler Kadıköylü değildirler, ... tarih boyunca, Ortodoks Kilisesi'nden ayrılmalarından ve Monofizitizm'e sapmalarından sonra oldukça kesin ve değişmez bir şekilde kafir olarak kabul edildiler."

ENTRANCE

The Armenian-Gregorian Church, being Monophysite, from the early Middle Ages in a somewhat modified form, adheres to the teachings of Eutychius, which is the basic basis of the Monophysite persuasion. This sense, as the world-famous Russian spiritual writer publicist of the twentieth century I. Talberg wrote, was created in 444 (Тальберг И., 1991: 157). In the Middle Ages, individual Eastern churches joined this sense, and among these churches was the Armenian Gregorian Church.

1. ON THE HISTORY OF MONOPHYSITISM IN THE ARMENIAN-GRIGORIAN CHURCH

The history of the Monophysitism of the Armenian-Gregorian Church began after the Council of Chalcedon, when the Monophysites headed for the lands of the Euphrates basin, which were inhabited by wandering Armenians and for that time was operated by the Armenian Church, founded by Gregory the Parthian (c. 252-334-335) in the first third of the 4th century. Having joined the Monophysites, the priests of the Armenian Gregorian Church accepted the teaching of Eutyches and declared that there is one person in Jesus Christ. Monophysitism of the Armenians was especially strong in the area of the right bank of the Euphrates (Great Armenia, also known as Persian Armenia), which was ceded to the Sasanian Empire under the terms of the treaty of 387. Under the terms of the same agreement, the area of the left bank of the Euphrates (Lesser Armenia, also known as Byzantine Armenia) was included in the Byzantine Empire, and monophysitism dominated here back in the 5th century. The Armenians of Lesser Armenia were distant from the central provinces of Byzantium and this factor had an impact on

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the isolation of the Armenians of this horonym, and another important factor was the heterogeneity of the ethnic environment of the Euphrates (Адонц Н., 1908: 202). These circumstances did not allow Byzantium in the early Middle Ages to implant in the minds of the Armenians of Lesser Armenia, who are far from Constantinople, dyophysitism - Orthodoxy. A similar situation prevailed in Caesarea, where the wandering Armenians in the early Middle Ages, staying in this area, knew little Latin and in the middle of the "V century they spoke their native language" (Адонц Н., 1908: 202).

In Persian Armenia, located in the area of the right bank of the Euphrates, the positions of Monophysitism were stronger, and the Armenians of this horonym included in the Sassanid Empire adhered to the Monophysite doctrine. This circumstance was explained primarily by the confessional policy of the Sasanian Empire, which encouraged Monophysitism. This policy was purposefully carried out from the period of the reign of the Shihinshahs Ezdigerd II and Khosrov I. The randomness was reflected in the ideology of the wandering Armenians and in 491, in the convened Council, the Armenian-Gregorian Church rejected the Cathedral of Chalcedon (Тальберг И., 1991: 168). Having become a centralized force and having gathered its flock around the Monophysite persuasion, the Armenian-Gregorian Church in 536 condemned the Council of Chalcedon "and from that time the Armenian Church fell away from the union with the Church of the Ecumenical" (Тальберг И., 1991: 169). Thus, the Armenian-Gregorian Church broke away from the original foundations of the Church, entered into heresy and did not recognize the Ecumenical Councils, starting from the IV Chalcedon, which adopted the definition of two natures in Christ, divine and human. The pre-revolutionary Russian apologist V. L. Velichko wrote about this period in the history of the Armenian Church in his writings, indicating that the Armenians "finally rejected the formula of the Chalcedon Cathedral and joined the Monophysites" (Величко В. Л., 1990: 76).

2. PRIMARY SOURCES ON THE MONOPHYSITIS OF THE ARMENIAN-GREGORIAN CHURCH

The Armenian clergy themselves wrote about the Monophysitism of the Armenians in the Middle Ages. Back in the middle of the 6th century, the Catholicos of the Armenian Gregorian Church İohann, in his letter to the Catholicos of the Albanian Apostolic Church Abbas, confirmed the monophysitism of the Armenian Gregorian Church: "We confess the One God, the Almighty Father, the creator of the universe, Jesus Christ the Son of God, born of the Father, the true God, from the true God, and he is everything ... At the end of the ages, the Eternal God, the Word of God, became a perfect man ... inexpressibly incarnated from the Holy Virgin, not moving away from nature and not decomposing in the flesh, God incarnate, not a part, but completely, not duality, and not a divided unity ... the only begotten from the Father, by the will, by the power of the Father and the Holy Spirit, by the nature of the Word of God" (Каганкатваццц Моисей, 1861: 93, 94). And so the Catholicos of the Armenian Gregorian Church İohann confirmed that the Armenian Gregorian Church, unlike the Orthodox Church, does not accept the two-nature nature of Jesus Christ, but one nature-divine. And therefore it is not Orthodox, but Monophysite.

The pre-revolutionary Russian historian N. Nikolsky also wrote about the Monophysitism of the Armenians. His article, included in the Encyclopedic Dictionary of the Russian Granat Bibliographic Institute, compiled under the editorship of famous scientists of pre-revolutionary Russia, confirms the monophysitism of the Armenian-Gregorian Church. On the matrix of truth, he shows the essence of the Monophysite Armenian-Gregorian Church: "The doctrine of this church differs from the Greek Orthodox one in that this doctrine affirms "the divine nature in Jesus, after his incarnation, completely swallowed up the human, so that in Jesus it is necessary to recognize not two natures, but one" (Энциклопедический словарь русского библиографического института Гранат, 1929: 283). Consequently, already at the end of the 19th century, the idea of the monophysite nature of the Armenian-Gregorian Church dominated in the scientific circles of Russia.

These realities were confirmed in Russia later. According to the clergy of modern Russia, the question of the nature of Christ is paramount for a Christian. In June 2012, the vicar of His Holiness the Patriarch of Moscow and All Russia, Archbishop Evgeny of Vereisky (Reshetnikov), touching upon this issue, focused on the essence of the Monophysite Armenian Church: "Although many Armenian theologians deny that they are Monophysites (recognize in Jesus Christ only the Divine nature, rejecting His humanity), the refusal to recognize the clear and precise teaching of the Council of Chalcedon about the two natures in Christ effectively makes it a Monophysite church. Armenians who wish to join the Orthodox Church must accept the decrees and rules of the IV-VII Ecumenical Councils" (www.patriarchia.ru, 09.06.2012).

3. ARMENIAN-GREGORIAN CHURCH RUSSIA: FROM PETER TO PAUL

After the collapse of Arshakid Armenia at the end of the 4th century, for centuries the Armenian-Gregorian Church was looking for a new country for its dispersed flock. At the beginning of the XVIII century, its eyes were directed to Russia, at the same time, young Peter I, was building royal plans for his state. Opening a "window to Europe", he aroused great interest in the wandering Armenians. Thus, the "Armenian question" wedged itself into the Russian policy of Peter I. A significant role in strengthening the favorable attitude of Romanov Russia towards wandering Armenians during the reign of Peter I was played by the Armenian-Gregorian Church, which, in the middle of the 16th century, in tandem with a rich layer of Armenian merchants, tried to form Armenian statehood, which became the core of the "Armenian issue". For almost two centuries, the Armenian Gregorian Church tried to draw the attention of Europe to the Armenian myth of "great Armenia". The emissary of the Armenian Gregorian Church, Israel Ori, wandering around Europe for many years, became convinced of the indifference of Europe to the "Armenian issue" and at the beginning of the 18th century turned to Romanov Russia with hope, presenting his project on the "Armenian issue" (Эзов Г.А., 1898: XXI), which was not destined to be realized. The unfinished mission of I. Ori was continued by the Armenian myth-makers at the end of the 18th century. Trying to draw the attention of the Russian court to the fictitious "Armenian issue", the Armenian Gregorian Church pulled off a scam by convincing Emperor Paul that they were just as Orthodox as the Orthodox Russian Orthodox Church. The author of this scam was Archbishop Joseph Argutinsky. Archbishop Joseph Argutinsky-Dolgorukiy went to the "Orthodox myth" for decades. This Armenian myth-maker originally bore the surname Argutashvili-Mkhagrdzeli. The pre-revolutionary Russian apologist V.L. Velichko pointed out that later Argutashvili-Mkhagrdzeli - Hovsep Arlutyan or Argutyan-Yerkaynabazuk "came into Russian use under the name Argutinsky-Dolgoruky" (Величко В. Л., 1990: 78).

During the reign of Catherine II, Archbishop Joseph, rotated in the government circles of Catherine's Russia and took part in shaping the contours of the Caucasian policy of Romanov Russia. Together with the well-known Armenian rich man from Julfa I. Lazarev, he was able to convince Catherine II to sign a letter dated November 14, 1779, which laid the foundation for the formation of the city of Nakhichevan-on-Don, inhabited by Armenians, a nomadic ethnic group resettled from Crimea by decree of Catherine II. Spreading the "Armenian issue" in Romanov Russia, Argutinsky-Dolgoruky became the ideological inspirer of the founding of the city of Grigoriopol in 1792 by decree of Catherine II. Near the Dniester River, between the Chernaya and Chernitsa rivers, on July 25, 1792, Archbishop I. Argutinsky illuminated the place and founded the city of Grigoriopol. Wandering Armenians from Wallachia, Bessarabia and the Ottoman Empire were gathered in this city, who were settled in the above-mentioned territories in different years. Archbishop Argutinsky-Dolgoruky spreaded the "Armenian issue" not only in Romanov Russia, he also closely maintained contact with the Indian colonists, in particular with Shaamirian's Madras group, which financially supported the actions of the Armenian-Gregorian Church in Russia. Joseph Argutinsky-Dolgoruky, exaggerating the "Armenian issue" in tandem with Ivan Lazarev, in his composed projects for the formation of Armenian statehood, expanded the area of "great Armenia" and transferred its localization to a territory alien to Armenians - to the lands of Azerbaijan. This was facilitated after the I Georgievsky Treaty (July 24 (August 4) 1783), the current socio-political situation in the Caucasian mega-region. Taking an active part in the campaign of Valerian Zubov in 1796, this myth-maker called on his flock to rally around Russia, hoping that this campaign would create favorable conditions for resolving the Armenian myth about "great Armenia".

After the death of the Empress, Argutinsky-Dolgoruky also entered the Pavlovsk Palace and, by hook or by crook, exaggerated Armenian myths. Acting on the algorithms of the "Armenian issue", he was spinning the myth about "great Armenia" invented by the Armenian-Gregorian Church. Having published in 1799 in St. Petersburg the book *"The Confession of the Christian Faiths of the Armenian Churches, Joseph of the Archbishop of the Armenian People Living in Russia"*, the Archbishop of the Armenian Gregorian Church, using the algorithms of Mkhitarism, hid the monophysitism of the Armenians. In the same year, when Emperor Paul I accepted the title of Grand Master of the Order of Malta, Argutinsky-Dolgoruky composed a liturgy especially for Emperor Paul. Presenting the composed liturgy to the Russian emperor, Argutinsky-Dolgoruky deceived Emperor Paul I by declaring that the Armenians were just as Orthodox as their Russian Orthodox brothers and that both sister churches, Armenian and Russian, were Orthodox. Proof of this, this Armenian clergyman convinced Paul I that in this liturgy the flock of the Monophysite Armenian Church "pray for both the Orthodox Emperor of All Russia and the August House" (Дашнаки, 1990: 9). Having believed the Argutinsky "legend", Romanov Russia accepted the wandering Armenians as confessionally homogeneous, close to Orthodoxy. And for almost 100 years in Russia, wandering Armenians were considered Orthodox. Thus, at the turn of the 19th century, fortune smiled on this nomadic ethnic group. In the highest circles of Romanov Russia,

these Eastern Christians were believed to be trustworthy and distinguished by their loyalty to Russia. Thus, the fictional Argutinsky fake led the Russian public to a delusion. According to this new legend, Archbishop Joseph presented the Monophysite Armenians as Orthodox Christians and achieved a favorable attitude of Romanov Russia towards them. At the same time, the Armenian-Gregorian Church drew up the contours of the "Armenian question" to the contours of the Caucasian policy of the Russian Empire. The indirect influence of the Armenian Gregorian Church on the Caucasian policy of the Russian Empire was mentioned in report submitted to the Holy Synod in 1907 by the prosecutor of the Synod of Etchmiadzin A. Frenkel. This report pointed to the position of the Russian government, which created a favorable situation, which served as "a precedent for future harassment of the Armenian Catholicos to create that exceptional position for their flock. which is regulated by the law of 1836." (История Азербайджана по документам и публикациям, 1990:77-82). According to the Regulations of April 10, 1836, the Senate of the Russian Empire gave the Albanian Apostolic Church to the control of the Armenian Gregorian Church. Thus, conditions were created for the unfounded claims of this Monophysite church to the heritage of the Albanian Apostolic Church, and later to the ancestral lands of Azerbaijan. Using this decree, the Armenian-Gregorian Church throughout the 19th century purposefully destroyed and plundered the Albanian heritage, which was an integral part of the history of Azerbaijan, paving the way for its unfounded territorial claims against Azerbaijan in the subsequent phases of the "Armenian issue".

It should be noted that the falsifications of Joseph Argutinsky-Dolgoruky in his writings were exposed by the Russian church historian, professor of the St. Petersburg Theological Academy, Doctor of Theology I.E. Troitsky. In his work *"Exposition of the Faith of the Armenian Churches"* he showed the realities of history. Another pre-revolutionary Russian church historian Alexander Anninsky in his book *"History of the Armenian Church"* also pointed out the monophysite nature of the Armenian-Gregorian Church (Величко В. Л., 1990:81). And only in 1891, this myth about the "Orthodoxy" of the Armenian Church was exposed during the trial of the Armenian priest Ter-Voskakov, where it turned out that the liturgy composed by Joseph Argutinsky-Dolgoruky was a fraud. The prosecutor of the Synod of Etchmiadzin Frenkel, having studied the composed liturgy of Joseph Argutinsky-Dolgoruky, found out that the service was always performed according to the order developed by the See of Echmiadzin, which constituted the codification of the former bishops, and this order was finally approved by Kevork VI in the seventies of the XIX century and was obligatory for Armenians all over the world. And most importantly, in the service there were no prayers for any Sovereign, as well as for the Russian, and also for any other Christians. In the first place there was only one Catholicos, and then the Gregorian Christians; all the rest, both Christians and non-believers, were "heretics and infidels" and were subject to damnation. Everyone - who not only attempts to oppress the Armenian Church, but even conniving. On the basis of such a teaching, the Russian royal house, after the adoption of the Sequestra of June 3, 1903, was cursed for the confiscation of the church property of the Armenian Gregorian Church (Дашнаки, 1990:9). Thus, the Monophysite Armenian Church decided to punish the House of Romanov.

CONCLUSION

Nowadays, the Greek clergyman, former protopresbyter of the Thessaloniki Metropolis, founder of the Society for Orthodox Education, professor of the theological faculty of the Aristotle University of Thessaloniki Theodore Zisis writes about the monophysitism of the Armenians. In his article "Are Armenians Orthodox?" he emphasized: "The non-Chalcedonian Armenians, that is, those who reject the IV Ecumenical Council, and with it all subsequent Ecumenical Councils, throughout history, quite definitely and invariably after their separation from the Orthodox Church and deviation into Monophysitism, are considered as heretics." However, the spiritual successors of Archbishop Joseph Argutinsky-Dolgoruky do not abandon the Argutinsky legend, which was turned into a "soap bubble" at the end of the 19th century. By launching into circulation neo-fake, which was exposed more than a hundred years ago, they are trying to obscure the essence of Monophysitism and repaint themselves in Orthodoxy, as it was at the end of the 18th century. But the myth-making of the Armenians is powerless in the face of the realities of History, which, on the basis of the matrix of truth, exposes falsifiers and says: the Armenian-Gregorian Church is Monophysite and not Orthodox.

SOURCE

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